LISA JANSSEN

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Education & Positions

2027 – **Postdoctoral Fellow** in Political Science — University of Zurich, Switzerland

- Project title: *Democratic Commitment and Reciprocity: A Relational Perspective on Citizens' Responses to Democratic Transgressions.*

2022 – 2027 **Ph.D.** in Political Science — Ghent University, Belgium

- Dissertation title: *Divided over democracy: The effects of affective polarization on citizens' democratic support.*
- Supervisors: Prof. dr. Anna Kern (Ghent University) and Prof. dr. Hannah Werner (University of Zurich).
- Visiting scholar at the **University of Zurich**, Switzerland (Sep 2024 – Nov 2024, Nov 2025, January 2026).
- Visiting scholar at the **European University Institute**, Italy (Mar 2025 – May 2025).
- Visiting scholar at **Aarhus University**, Denmark (March 2026 – May 2026).
- Doctoral Advisory Committee: Prof. dr. Suthan Krishnarajan, Prof. dr. Yphtach Lelkes, and Prof. dr. Markus Wagner.

2020 – 2022 **Research Master's** Social Sciences — University of Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Highest distinction: *Cum Laude* (GPA: 89/100), top 3% of the 181 students who have obtained their degree between 2016 and 2022 (P97%).

2017 – 2020 **B.Sc.** in Political Science — University of Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Highest distinction: *Cum Laude* (GPA: 83/100).
- Honours program (additional 30 ECTs) (GPA: 87/100), Vrije Universiteit and UvA.

2016 – 2020 **B.Sc.** in Communication Science — University of Amsterdam, Netherlands

- Highest distinction: *Cum Laude* (GPA: 80/100).

Research

Research Fields: Political Behaviour, Political Psychology, & Comparative Politics.

Research Interests: Democratic Commitment, Polarization, Political Trust, Democratic Legitimacy, Norms, & Morality.

Peer-Reviewed Articles

(6) **Janssen, L.**, Werner, H., & Kern, A. (2026). 'When they go low, we kick them': The reciprocal nature of citizens' support for democratic transgressions. *Journal of Politics*, Just Accepted. https://doi.org/10.1086/744129

(5) Van der Meer, T.W.G., & **Janssen, L.** (2025). Pushing & Pulling: The Static and Dynamic Effects of Political Distrust on Support for Representative Democracy and its Rivals. *Political Behavior, 47*, 1389-1411. https://doi.org/10.1007/s11109-024-09994-y

(4) **Janssen, L.**, & Turkenburg, E. (2025). Breaking free from linear assumptions: Unravelling the relationship between affective polarization and democratic support. *European Journal of Political Research, 64*(3), 1465-1479. https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.12725

(3) **Janssen, L.** (2024). Sweet victory, bitter defeat: The amplifying effects of affective and perceived ideological polarization on the winner–loser gap in political support. *European Journal of Political Research, 63*, 455–477. https://doi.org/10.1111/1475-6765.12625

(2) **Janssen, L.**, Zwier, D., & Van de Werfhorst, H. (2024). Privatization of preschool education: The implications for educational inequalities in cross-national perspective. *Acta Sociologica, 67*(3), 282-300. https://doi.org/10.1177/00016993231205201

(1) Van der Meer, T.W.G., **Janssen, L.**, & Louwerse, T. (2023). The predictive value of polls in a fragmented multi-party system: the Netherlands (1998–2021). *Acta Politica, 58*, 461–482. https://doi.org/10.1057/s41269-022-00250-x

Working Papers

(4) Mundschenk, L., **Janssen, L.**, Werner, H., Reiljan, A., & Cicchi, L. (2026). Heated Opinions: Issue-based affective polarization over climate change. R&R at *Nature Humanities and Social Sciences Communications*.

(3) **Janssen, L.**, Van Lit, J., & Werner, H. (2026). Democratic commitment under democratic backsliding: How citizens evaluate moral dilemmas in resistance to autocratization. *Under review.*

(2) Van Lit, J., **Janssen, L.**, & Werner, H. (2026). Fight fire with fire? The electoral appeal of undemocratic resistance strategies. *Under review.*

(1) Ingelbeen, J., **Janssen, L.**, & Hesstvedt, S. (2026). Trust Criteria and (the Conditional Appeal of) Technocracy.

Work in progress

(3) **Janssen, L.**, Colombo, F., & Devine, D. (2026). How Citizens Respond to Democratic Transgressions: A Meta-reanalysis of Experimental Evidence.

(2) **Janssen, L.** (2026). Does reciprocating undemocratic behavior deter or escalate public tolerance for further norm-breaking?

(1) Werner, H., **Janssen, L.**, Mundschenk, L., & Gomm, S. (2026). In Search of the Red Line: A Coordination Approach to Measuring Constraints on Democratic Resistance.

Book chapters & articles (not reviewed)

(3) **Janssen, L.** (2024). Hyperpolitiek: Extreme politisering zonder politieke gevolgen. *Samenleving & Politiek, 31*(6), 85-87.

(2) **Janssen, L.** (2021). Casus II: Het Deense Windwonder. In Nieuwenhuis, E. (Ed.), Groene Industriepolitiek: Bouwen aan een Groene Eeuw (pp. 91-96). *Wetenschappelijk Bureau GroenLinks.*

(1) **Janssen, L.** (2021). Casus III: Groene Staal uit Zweden. In Nieuwenhuis, E. (Ed.), Groene Industriepolitiek: Bouwen aan een Groene Eeuw (pp. 125-130). *Wetenschappelijk Bureau GroenLinks.*

Popular scientific blogs & media publications

(4) Turkenburg, E., & **Janssen, L.** (2025). Polarisatie is niet altijd slecht voor de democratie. *StukRoodVlees*. https://stukroodvlees.nl/polarisatie-is-niet-altijd-slecht-voor-de-democratie/

(3) **Janssen, L.** (2024). Zoete overwinning, bittere nederlaag: Het verliezen van verkiezingen ten tijde van polarisatie. *GASPAR blogt*. https://gasparblogt.wordpress.com/2023/11/13/zoete-overwinning-bittere-nederlaag-het-verliezen-van-verkiezingen-ten-tijde-van-polarisatie.

(2) **Janssen, L.** (2023). Losing the vote, losing the faith: Electoral defeat in polarised times. *ECPR The Loop*. https://theloop.ecpr.eu/losing-the-vote-losing-the-faith-electoral-defeat-in-polarised-times/.

(1) **Janssen, L.**, & Van der Meer, T.W.G. (2023). Wat zeggen Eerste Kamerverkiezingen en peilingen over de uitslag van de Tweede Kamerverkiezingen? *StukRoodVlees*. https://stukroodvlees.nl/wat-zeggen-eerste-kamerverkiezingen-en-peilingen-over-de-uitslag-van-de-tweede-kamerverkiezingen/

Grants & Awards

2027 **Swiss National Science Foundation** +/- €700,000

International Co-Investigator Scheme (Project Funding) with Hannah Werner (UZH) and Honorata Mazepus (UvA) for project titled: Democratic Commitment and Reciprocity: A Relational Perspective on Citizens' Responses to Democratic Transgressions.

2026 **Mobility and Research Faculty Fund Ghent University** €2,200

Travel grant awarded for a research stay at Aarhus University, Denmark

2025 **Research Grant University of Zürich** CHF 10,000

Research grant awarded by the Department of Political Science of the University of Zürich for data-collection on democratic dilemmas in resistance among minority groups, together with Hannah Werner.

Research Foundation Flanders (FWO) Travel Grant €1,000

Travel grant awarded for participation in the APSA Annual conference in Vancouver, Canada

ECPR Event Participation Grant £500

Travel grant awarded by the European Political Science Consortium for participation in the Joint Sessions of Workshops in Prague, Czechia

2024 **Research Grant University of Zürich** CHF 7,000

Research grant awarded by the Department of Political Science of the University of Zürich for data-collection on citizens' democratic commitments, together with Hannah Werner

Top cited article achievement European Journal of Political Research

Top cited article certificate of achievement awarded by the European Journal of Political Research to the 10 most cited papers published by the journal in 2023 for the paper 'Sweet victory, bitter defeat: The amplifying effects of affective and perceived ideological polarization on the winner-loser gap in political support'.

Mobility and Research Faculty Fund Ghent University €3,000

Travel grant awarded for a research stay at the University of Zurich, Switzerland

Research Foundation Flanders (FWO) Travel Grant €1,000

Travel grant awarded for participation in the workshop on Democratic Decline and Resilience at the University of Montréal, Canada.

Course Organization Grant Doctoral Schools €3,660

Doctoral Schools Grant for organizing a PhD-course on 'Open Science' by Prof. dr. Godefroidt at Ghent University

2023 **Course Organization Grant Doctoral Schools** €4,500

Doctoral Schools Grant for organizing a PhD-course on 'Causality in Quantitative Research' by Prof. dr. Daphne van der Pas at Ghent University

FWO Fundamental Research PhD Fellowship +/- €175,000

Research Foundation Flanders (FWO) grant for a personal project titled 'Divided by Democracy: The effects of affective polarization on citizens' democratic support in Europe'

Grant Special Research Fund Doctoral Scholarship (BOF) +/- €175,000

Ghent University Grant for a personal project titled 'Divided by Democracy: The effects of affective polarization on citizens' democratic support in Europe'. The grant was discontinued in November 2023 after receiving the FWO fellowship.

2022 **Course Organization Grant Doctoral Schools** €4,500

Doctoral Schools Grant for organizing a PhD-course on 'Experimental Methods in the Social Sciences' by Prof. dr. Bert Bakker at Ghent University

Nomination Daniel Heinsius Prize

Nominated for the best political science master thesis in the Netherlands and Flanders

Teaching & Supervision

Qualifications: Learning Track for Assistants, certificate of completion.

2024, 2025, 2026 **Lecturer Quantitative Research and Introduction to R, Ghent University**

I developed a new course (8 lectures & tutorials) on Quantitative Research Methods & Introduction to R for students in the third year of the Bachelor's Political Science at Ghent University. Course materials are available upon request and have been adopted in other courses at Ghent University and University of Zurich. Student evaluation average: 4.6/5.

2026 **Lecturer 'Elections & Representation', Ghent University**

Designed a new master's-level course comprising 8 lectures and tutorials on contemporary challenges to democracy (Sep–Dec 2026). Topics include autocratization, political accountability, democratic commitment, losers' consent, and polarization.

2024, 2025, 2026 **Supervisor Bachelor's and Master's students, Ghent University and the University of Zurich**

Thesis Co-supervisor of Master's Students (6) and Bachelor's Students (9).

2026 **Tutor Academic Writing Master Thesis, Ghent University**

Workshop on academic writing and thesis structure for master's students.

2025 **Guest Lecturer, University of Zürich**

Lectures on 'Democratic Threats from Within: Elites and Polarization' and 'Democratization & Autocratization' at the University of Zurich Bachelor Political Science.

2024, 2025 **Workshop on AI in the Social Sciences**

Developed and taught a workshop on how AI and LLMs can be used in Social Science Research for the Gaspar research group at Ghent University and the Political Science academic staff at the University of Zurich.

2024 **Workshop on Open Science in the Social Sciences**

Developed and taught a workshop on open science practices (pre-registration, replication packages, open-access publishing) for the Gaspar research group at Ghent University.

Conferences, Workshops & Invited Talks

2026	EPSS Annual Conference, Belfast, Northern Ireland	*Presenter*
	"The democratic dilemma of resistance", Copenhagen, Denmark	*Invited talk*
	Political Behavior Workshop, Aarhus University, Denmark	*Presenter*
	Affective Polarization Workshop, Aarhus University, Denmark	*Participant*
	Swiss Political Science Conference, Zurich, Switzerland	*Presenter*
2025	APSA Annual Conference, Vancouver, Canada	*Discussant & Presenter*
	EPSA 15th Annual Conference, Madrid, Spain	*Panel Chair & Presenter*
	Citizens' democratic commitment in times of affective polarization, ECPR Joint Sessions, Prague, Czechia	*Workshop Director & Presenter*
	"Divided over democracy: The effects of affective polarization on democratic support" EGPP Seminar, European University Institute, Florence, Italy	*Invited Talk*

	EGPP Annual Conference: "Resisting autocracy: actors, challenges, and tools for democratic resilience", European University Institute, Florence, Italy	*Invited Talk*
	Conference on Political Trust, University of Amsterdam, the Netherlands	*Invited Participant*
	The reciprocal nature of citizens' support for democratic transgressions, GI Seminars, University of Lisboa, Portugal	*Invited Talk*
2024	Villa Vigoni, workshop "Contesting the rules of the game? Political conflict, polarization and procedural consensus", Lake Como, Italy	*Presenter*
	ECPR General Conference, University College Dublin, Ireland	*Chair of three panels & Presenter*
	EPSA 14th Annual Conference, Cologne, Germany	*Presenter*
	Workshop "Towards affective depolarisation?", European University Institute, Florence, Italy	*Invited Talk*
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries, Maastricht University, the Netherlands	*Panel Organizer & Presenter*
2023	Symposium on Affective Polarisation, Maastricht University, the Netherlands	*Presenter*
	Interdisciplinary workshop: Affective polarization and democracy, University of Amsterdam, the Netherlands	*Participant*
	ECPR General Conference, Charles University, Czechia	*Presenter*
	EPSA 13th Annual Conference, Glasgow, United Kingdom	*Presenter*
	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries KU Leuven, Belgium	*Panel Organizer & Presenter*
2022	Annual Political Science Workshops of the Low Countries, Radboud University, Netherlands	*Presenter*

Additional Education & Training

2025	**Summer School for Women in Political Methodology** Prof. Dr. Theresa Gessler & Prof. Dr. Sophia Hunger	University of Bremen, Germany
	Open science in the Social Sciences Prof. Dr. Amelie Godefroidt	Ghent University, Belgium
2024	**Learning track for teachers** Mansi Sharma & Margo Dewispelaere	Ghent University, Belgium
	Summer school on "Democratic Decline and Resilience" Prof. Dr. Ruth Dassonneville and Prof. Dr. Romain Lachet	University of Montréal, Canada
2023	**PhD course on "Causality in Quantitative Methods"** Prof. Dr. Daphne van der Pas	Ghent University, Belgium
	ECPR Winter School "Introduction to Bayesian Estimation" Prof. dr. Susumu Shikano	KU Leuven, Belgium
	Workshop "Experimental Methods" Prof. Dr. Bert Bakker	Ghent University, Belgium
2022	**Workshop "Statistical Power Analysis"** Dr. Niklas Johannes	KU Leuven, Belgium

Professional Experience

2022 – 2024 Research Assistant - Prof. Dr. Tom Van der Meer University of Amsterdam, Netherlands
Department of Political Science, co-author on a project about seat polls in The Netherlands as well as co-author on a project on the consequences of political distrust.

2020 – 2021 Research Assistant - Prof. Dr. Bram Lancee University of Amsterdam, Netherlands
Department of Sociology, data-analyses, codebook-development, and theoretical input on a project on discrimination and SDO.

2021 Research Assistant University of Copenhagen, Denmark
Department of Sociology, translating Dutch datasets.

2020 Research Assistant - Dr. Paula Thijs & Dr. Frank Wanders University of Amsterdam, Netherlands
Department of Political Science, data-collection (in the field) and data analyses on the ADKS-project.

2020 Research Intern Scientific Bureau of GroenLinks, Utrecht, Netherlands
Co-author on a book about 'Industrial politics', aimed at providing a framework for a more sustainable heavy-industry in the Netherlands.

2019-2020 Data-analysis Intern Mediahuis, Amsterdam, Netherlands
De Telegraaf Data-analyst

2019 Research Assistant - Dr. Edina Strikovic University of Amsterdam, Netherlands
Department of Communication Science, coding tweets and political debates on the use of the word 'the people' by (populist) politicians.

Media Coverage

BE De Morgen, De Ochtend Radio 1, Samenleving & Politiek, GASPAR Blogt.

DE Deutschlandfunk Radio

ES ElDiario.es

EU The Loop ECPR.

FR EU!radio, podcast 'Ideas on Europe'.

NL NOS, NRC, Volkskrant, De Telegraaf, Radio 1, Metro, Leidsch Dagblad, De Limburger, De Correspondent, Podcast De Correspondent, StukRoodVlees.

Service to the Community

2026 **Organizing Committee Annual Workshops of the Low Countries**
Organized the Annual Workshops of the Low Countries conference as part of the local organizing team at Ghent.

2024 – **Board Member VPW**
Board Member and Social media manager of the Belgian Political Science Association (Vereniging voor Politieke Wetenschappen).

2024 – **Reviewer**

Completed 50+ reviews, including: American Journal of Political Science, Journal of Politics, British Journal of Political Science, European Journal of Political Research, Political Behavior, Political Psychology, Democratization, West European Politics, Party Politics, Public Opinion Quarterly, Government & Opposition, Nature Humanities and Social Sciences Communications, European Political Science Review, Electoral Studies, Acta Sociologica, Political Research Exchange, European Societies, Politics, Social Inclusion, Analyses of Social Issues and Public Policy, International Journal of Politics, Culture, and Society, Parliamentary Affairs.

2024 – **Replication**

Participation in multiple replication games from the I4R as well as the synthetic Replication Games (using LLM samples)

2023 – **Panel Chair & Organizer**

EPSA Annual Conference 2025, ECPR Joint Sessions 2025, Annual Political Science Workshops of The Low Countries 2024, ECPR General Conference 2024, Annual Political Science Workshops of The Low Countries 2023, ECPR General Conference 2023.

2022 – **Organizer PhD Courses & Gaspar Lecture Series**

I organized courses on Experimental Methods, Causality in Quantitative Research, & Open Science for PhD students in Flanders. Moreover, I co-organized the monthly Gaspar Lecture Series, where we invite scholars to present their work at Ghent University.

Skills

Languages: English (fluent); Dutch (native).

Software: R, Stata, Python, Qualtrics, SPSS, LaTeX, MaxQDA, Atlas.ti, G*power, MSOffice.

Methods:

- Quasi-experimental and Time-series analyses: Multilevel Growth Curve Modelling; Random Effects Within–Between Models; Difference-in-Differences; Autoregression.
- Survey experiments: Vignette experiments; Conjoint experiments.
- Text analyses: LLM-based Text Annotation; LLooM (LLM-based concept induction); Topic Modelling; Qualitative abductive coding.
- Data analyses: Multilevel Modelling; Generalized Additive Modelling; Structural Equation Modelling; Bayesian Estimation; Meta-(re)analyses; Power-analyses; Measurement Modelling.

References

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